

EDUCATION

Pennsylvania State University
Information Sciences and Technology
Ph.D. in Human-Computer Interaction
Grad. Aug 2019

East China Normal University
B.S. in Computer Science
Grad. May 2013

SKILLS

🎓 Research methods

Qualitative:

Interview • Contextual Inquiry • Focus Group • Diary Studies • Field Studies • Cognitive Walkthrough • Affinity Diagram • Think-aloud • Usability Test • Literature Review • Scenario Based Design • Design Sprint

Quantitative:

Experiment Design • Evals • HaTS • Survey • Log Analysis • Factor Analysis • Regression • Kano Modeling • TURF Analysis • MaxDiff • A/B Testing

</> Programming

Languages:

HTML/CSS • Python • JavaScript • R • SQL • C++

WORK EXPERIENCE

Google Oct 2019 – Present
Senior UX Researcher | Google Workspace & Core Data Sunnyvale, CA

GenAI Productivity • 0-to-1 UXR • Data Science Partnership

- **0-to-1 AI Product Research:** Led end-to-end exploratory and evaluative research for Google's multimodal AI creation tool (announced Google I/O 2026) across Consumer and Business tiers; established Evals rubrics and in-product HaTS measurement that directly de-risked and steered the General Availability launch.
- **Enterprise GenAI Productivity:** Pioneered enterprise GenAI productivity research, formulating a value framework beyond "time savings"; delivered executive briefs and authored peer-reviewed research (ACM DIS 2025) on knowledge worker adoption.
- **Behavioral Analytics & Data Science Partnership:** Partnered closely with Data Science to explain attribution and churn of app installations, and applied log analysis of 3P sign-in attempts to size the opportunity for strengthening the narrative on 0-1 new product investment.
- **Cross-Functional Roadmap Influence:** Shaped a multi-quarter platform roadmap across 20+ PMs by defining trigger-action CUIs for Workflow Automation and 3P Extensibility, fielding a quantitative survey to prioritize partner integrations.

Airbnb May – Aug 2018
User Experience Research Intern San Francisco, CA

- Drove research and redesign to increase the booking rate of new listings, and quantified the business value of new hosts' community involvement on their long-term hosting journey.

Pennsylvania State HCI Lab Sept 2013 – Aug 2019
0-1 platform builder and UXR State College, PA

Psychometric Validation • Quasi-Experimental Validation

📈 Technical Research Projects

- **Full-Stack Prototyping for Social Slackbot and Web Application:** Developed a custom messaging application to evaluate digital community dynamics. Built data-logging infrastructure to capture user behavioral patterns.
- **Quasi-experiments and deployment:** Validated a 5-factor psychometric framework via EFA/CFA on a large-scale survey ($N = 740$); triangulated survey data with behavioral logs using ANCOVA/regression to quantify engagement drivers.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Sun, N., & Kalar, D. Gemini at Work: Knowledge Workers' Perceptions and Assessment of Productivity Gains. Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (**DIS 2025**) [Acceptance: 25%]

Sun, N., Wang, X. Y., & Rosson, M. B. How Do Distance Learners Connect? Proceedings of the 37th annual ACM conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (**CHI 2019**) [Best Paper Honourable Mention Award: top 4%]

Sun, N., Rosson, M. B., & Carroll, J. M. Where is Community Among Online Learners? Identity, Efficacy and Personal Ties. Proceedings of the 36th annual ACM conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (**CHI 2018**) [Acceptance: 25.7%]